Nikki.

FREE GUIDE · CLINIC OWNERS & MANAGERS

The Clinic *SOP* Starter Pack

A simple SOP format plus ready-to-adapt templates for new-patient intake, scheduling and confirmations, the daily huddle and escalations.

04



Nikhila (Nikki) Mamanduri
Healthcare Operations Manager · MHA, CAPM

WHY SOPS

Good care shouldn't depend on who's at the desk today.

Building SOPs, escalation pathways and dashboards is a big part of my work in clinic operations — across patient access, scheduling, provider operations, compliance and retention. Clear SOPs are what let a team stay consistent as it grows, onboard new people faster and rely less on memory.

The one-page SOP format

Section	What to write
Title · ID · Version · Owner · Review date	So everyone knows which version is current and who maintains it.
Purpose	One sentence: why this process exists and what "done well" means.
Scope	Who does it, and when it applies (and when it doesn't).
Steps	Numbered, one action per step, in the order it happens. Include the system screen or form used.
Exceptions & escalation	What to do when something goes wrong, and who to tell.
Measures	The one or two numbers that show it's working.

Writing tips: start each step with a verb · write for a new hire on their first day · keep it to one page where possible · walk through it with the people who do the work before you publish · set a review date (every 6–12 months).

SOP 01 · NEW-PATIENT INTAKE

Purpose: Every new patient arrives verified, informed and with paperwork complete.
Scope: Front desk / patient access, for all new-patient appointments.

1. At booking, capture name, DOB, phone, email, reason for visit, payer, member ID and referral (if required).
2. Send the digital intake packet and consents within 1 business day of booking.
3. Verify eligibility and benefits 2–3 business days before the visit; start prior auth if required.
4. Call or text the patient with cost estimate, what to bring (ID, insurance card, medication list) and arrival time.
5. The day before, confirm the packet is complete; call to help if not.
6. At check-in, scan ID and insurance, read back demographics, collect copay.

Escalate: missing auth or eligibility issue → practice manager, the day before. **Measures:** % of packets complete before arrival · check-in time.

SOP 02 · SCHEDULING & CONFIRMATIONS

1. Book using the provider's template; never double-book outside agreed rules.
2. Confirm the visit type and length match the reason for visit.
3. Send confirmation with date, time, location, what to bring and how to reschedule.
4. Send reminders 3 days and 1 day before, with a confirm/reschedule option.
5. Offer cancelled slots to the same-day waitlist within the hour.
6. For no-shows, call the same day and offer a new time; note the outcome.

Measures: no-show rate · same-day cancellations · waitlist fills.

SOP 03 · 10-MINUTE DAILY HUDDLE

When: every morning before the first patient · **Who:** front desk, clinical lead, manager · **Where:** standing, by the schedule.

Minutes	Agenda item
0–2	Yesterday: anything that went wrong or went really well?
2–5	Today's schedule: new patients, complex visits, gaps to fill, late starts.
5–7	Exceptions: missing auths, incomplete paperwork, balances to discuss.
7–9	Staffing and supplies: coverage, breaks, anything running low.
9–10	One shout-out, and one thing we're improving this week.

SOP 04 · ESCALATION PATHWAY

Situation	First contact	If unresolved in…	Escalate to
Patient complaint at the desk	Front-desk lead	15 min	Practice manager
Missing auth on day of visit	Auth coordinator	Before the visit	Practice manager + provider
System or phone outage	Manager on duty	30 min	IT / vendor support
Staffing gap	Practice manager	Same morning	Operations leadership
Safety or privacy concern	Manager on duty	Immediately	Compliance / leadership

Adapt the timings, roles and systems to your clinic — these are starting points, not policy.

NEXT STEP

Want SOPs built *around your clinic?*

If you'd like help mapping your patient journey and turning it into SOPs, escalation pathways and a simple dashboard, book a free intro call and we'll see where to start.

Session	Length	Price	Best for
Intro call	15 min	Free	Say hello and see if we're a fit.
Mentoring chat	30 min	Free	Career questions, MHA advice or a resume review.
Working session	60 min	On request	A focused session on your clinic or project.

Save my digital card

Scan to save my contact, book a call from my website, or connect on LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/nikki-mamanduri

About Nikki. Nikhila (Nikki) Mamanduri is a Healthcare Operations Manager at Medi-Weightloss® Thousand Oaks with an MHA from the University of New Haven (3.79 GPA) and PMI's CAPM®. She has worked across medical devices (Relisys), dialysis (U.S. Renal Care), academic medicine (Tufts Medicine) and clinic operations, and believes better systems create stronger teams — and a better experience for every patient.

This guide shares general operational practices for educational purposes. It isn't legal, billing-compliance, immigration or medical advice — check payer rules, your organization's policies and the relevant authorities for your situation.